

indexed and searched, like almost anything else on Google, Scholar aims to make research all the more efficient by speeding up one particular aspect - looking for reference material. Released way back in November 2004, it is one of the earliest Google offerings to still be active. The platform includes most peer-reviewed online academic journals and books, theses, conference papers, technical reports, and other scholarly literature, even including court opinions and patents.



In terms of features, Google Scholar has grown over the years with support for citation managers, dedicated author profiles, a personal search result library and more. It is particularly useful even beyond core scientific research, since its index also helps retrieve published court opinions over a large set of records. There have also been several identified issues as well as problematic effects of Google Scholar, one of them even being termed as the Google Scholar effect where some researchers pick and cite works appearing in the top results on Google Scholar regardless of their contribution to the citing publication because they automatically assume these works' credibility and believe that editors, reviewers, and readers expect to see these citations. Regardless, Google Scholar continues to be a very powerful and useful tool for the academic community.

While Google Scholar's indexing is restricted to academic publications, Google Books aims to index all the books on the planet - reading them through OCR and making every single word searchable. While it does succeed in that goal, don't go on assuming that you can avail any book for free just by searching it on Google Books - publications still within copyright have limited text visible in the search results. On the

